

Word family: **alone / aloneness**

Base word: alone

Related form: aloneness

Part of speech: adjective-like predicative form (表語形容詞用法) / adverb (副詞)

Your sentence:

> “That **alone** makes me curious...”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **alone** means **by itself, without needing anything else to be added**.

The speaker means that **the single fact that the book keeps appearing everywhere is already enough to make him curious**.

繁體中文：***單憑這一點本身就已經足夠；僅僅這一點**

中文翻譯：

> “That **alone** makes me curious...”

「**單是這一點本身**就已經令我很好奇.....」

Here:

that alone = 單憑那一點 / 僅僅那件事本身

1. **alone = without other people (人物) — 獨自；單獨一人**

This is the most central meaning.

Meaning: Without other people being present or accompanying you.

Practice 1

> “She lives **alone**.”

「她**獨自居住**。」

Practice 2

> “I travelled **alone** for the first time.”

「我第一次**獨自旅行**。」

alone = 沒有其他人陪伴或在場，自己一個人

Common:

- * live alone
- * travel alone
- * eat alone
- * be alone
- * walk alone

2. **alone = without help or assistance (獨力) — 獨力；自己完成**

Alone can mean doing something without help from other people.

Practice 3

> “She completed the project **alone**.”

「她**獨力**完成了這個項目。」

Practice 4

> “You do not have to solve this **alone**.”

「你不需要**獨自 / 單靠自己**解決這件事。」

alone = 沒有別人協助，只靠自己完成或承擔某事

This is closely related to Meaning 1, but the emphasis is not physical company; it is **absence of assistance**.

For strict counting, I would merge it with #1 under the broad concept:

> **without other people**

3. **alone = only / by itself, without anything else (限定) — 單憑；僅僅；光是**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

****Meaning:**** Used to emphasize that one person, thing, fact, or reason is sufficient by itself.

Practice 5 — Original

> “That ****alone**** makes me curious.”

「****單是那一點****就令我很好奇。」

Practice 6

> “The cost ****alone**** would stop many people from buying it.”

「****單是價格****就足以令很多人打消購買念頭。」

Practice 7

> “Her experience ****alone**** makes her a strong candidate.”

「****單憑她的經驗****就足以令她成為很有力的人選。」

****X alone = 單憑 X 本身；沒有其他因素也已經足夠****

This is a genuinely distinct learner meaning from:

> “She lives alone.”

Compare:

> ****He alone knew the answer.****

> = 只有他知道答案。

> ****He lived alone.****

> = 他獨自生活。

Same word, different concept.

4. ****alone = only one person/thing among others (唯一) — 只有.....；唯獨.....****

****Alone**** can emphasize that one person or thing, and no others, fits a statement.

Practice 8

> “She ****alone**** understood what had happened.”

「**只有她**明白發生了甚麼事。」

Practice 9

> “This reason **alone** is enough to reject the proposal.”

「**單是這個理由**就足以否決該建議。」

X alone = 只有 X ; 唯獨 X ; 其他人 / 事物都不包括在內

This overlaps strongly with Meaning 3.

For core counting, I would merge #3 and #4 under:

> **only / by itself**

5. **alone = separate / isolated from others (孤立) — 單獨存在的 ; 與其他分開的**

A thing can sometimes be **alone** in the sense of being separate or isolated.

Practice 10

> “The house stood **alone** on the hill.”

「那間屋**孤零零地**立在山上。」

Practice 11

> “One tree remained **alone** in the field.”

「田野裡只剩下一棵樹**孤零零地**立着。」

alone = 與其他同類分開、獨自存在

This is still conceptually close to the basic **without others** sense, so I would not count it separately.

6. **leave someone/something alone = 不打擾 ; 別管**

This is an important fixed construction.

Practice 12

> “Please leave me **alone**.”

「請**別打擾我 / 讓我一個人靜一靜**。」

Practice 13

> “Leave the machine **alone** until it cools down.”

「在機器冷卻之前，**不要動它 / 別碰它**。」

leave someone/something alone = 不打擾、不干涉、不觸碰某人 / 某物

This is a fixed expression rather than a separate core meaning of bare **alone**.

7. **let alone** = 更不用說；遑論

This is another highly useful fixed construction.

Practice 14

> “He can barely walk, **let alone** run.”

「他連走路都很勉強，**更不用說**跑步。」

Practice 15

> “I cannot afford a bicycle, **let alone** a car.”

「我連單車都買不起，**更不用說**汽車。」

let alone B = 前面的 A 已經做不到 / 不成立，更不用說程度更高的 B

This is a fixed discourse expression and should not inflate the core meaning count.

8. **all alone** = 完全獨自一人

All intensifies the basic alone sense.

Practice 16

> “The child was sitting there all **alone**.”

「那個孩子**孤零零一個人**坐在那裡。」

Practice 17

> “I spent the evening all **alone**.”

「我整個晚上都**獨自一人**。」

all alone = 完全沒有其他人陪伴；孤零零一人

This belongs to Meaning 1.

Related form: **aloneness**

Aloneness means the state of being alone.

Practice 18

> “He enjoyed the quiet **aloneness** of the early morning.”

「他享受清晨安靜的**獨處狀態**。」

aloneness = 獨自一人的狀態

This is a valid word but much less common than:

* solitude

* being alone

So it is a lower-priority family form.

Important distinction: **alone vs lonely**

This is one of the most important learner contrasts.

alone

= physically without other people

lonely

= sad because you lack company or connection

> “She lives alone.”

does ****not**** necessarily mean:

> “She is lonely.”

A person can enjoy being alone and not feel lonely.

So:

****alone = 獨自****

****lonely = 孤單、寂寞****

Important distinction: ****alone vs only****

These overlap in your passage-type use.

**alone**

often follows the noun/pronoun it emphasizes:

> “That alone is enough.”

**only**

usually comes before the focused item:

> “Only that is enough.”

Both can mean:

> 只有那一點

But ****alone**** often emphasizes:

> ****that one factor by itself is sufficient****

So:

> “The price alone is a problem.”

has a strong sense of:

> **單是價格本身就已經成問題**

Important distinction: **alone vs by yourself**

alone

is concise and neutral:

> “I went alone.”

by yourself

often emphasizes doing something without company or help:

> “Did you do all this by yourself?”

They often overlap, but **by yourself** can foreground self-reliance more strongly.

Important distinction: **alone vs solitary**

alone

is the everyday word.

solitary

is more formal and can describe:

- * being alone
- * isolated existence
- * activities done alone

> solitary walk

> solitary life

Solitary often sounds more literary or descriptive.

Important distinction: **alone vs isolated**

alone

simply means without others.

isolated

suggests separation from others and often distance, disconnection, or lack of contact.

A person can be alone temporarily without being isolated.

Countability / grammar note

Alone is unusual because it is generally **not used before a noun** in ordinary English.

Natural:

> "She is alone."

> "She lives alone."

Usually unnatural:

> "an alone person" ❌

Instead use:

> "a solitary person"

> "a person who is alone"

This grammatical restriction is very useful for learners.

Family-extension note

The practical morphological family is genuinely small:

* **alone**

* **aloneness**

Most learning value comes from grammatical and fixed constructions:

* be alone

* live alone

- * X alone
- * all alone
- * leave someone alone
- * let alone

The Golden Manual says small word families should remain small rather than being padded artificially, while grammar-rich constructions still need to be covered carefully.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
----- -----	
alone — without people	沒有其他人陪伴或在場；獨自一人
alone — without help	沒有別人協助，只靠自己完成或承擔
X alone — only/by itself	單憑某一個人、事物、因素本身；僅僅這一點
alone — isolated/separate	與其他人或事物分開、獨自存在；屬於 without-others 義
all alone	完全獨自一人；孤零零地
leave someone alone	不打擾、不干涉某人 / 某物
let alone	更不用說；遑論
aloneness	獨自一人的狀態；較低頻

For your original sentence

> “That ****alone**** makes me curious...”

The exact meaning is:

****alone = 單憑這一件事本身，就已經足夠產生某個結果****

So:

> ****That alone makes me curious.****

= ****單是那一點本身，就已經令我很好奇。****

This does ****not**** mean:

> “That is by itself physically.”

It means:

> ****even without considering any other reason, that one fact is sufficient.****

For your database, I would count ****2 genuinely useful core meanings**** for ****alone****:

1. ****without other people/help; by oneself****

2. **only/by itself — one person, thing, or factor is sufficient or exclusive**

I would merge isolated/separate physical uses into #1, and keep **all alone, leave someone alone, let alone** as fixed constructions rather than inflate the core count.